unity in diversity. 'India encircled by seas and mountains, is indisputably a geographical unit' (V.A. Smith, Early History of India*). 'There is no part of the world better marked out by nature as a region by itself than India exclusive of Burmah' (Chisholm:* Geography*).*

Ethnologically they belong to the same Aryan race, except in some parts of India, but even there they have been assimilated. The whole of India was Hinduized long before Alexander invaded India in 315 B.C. The Hindu religion absorbed into its fold all the non-Aryan races, with the result that Hindu culture became the predominant culture of India. this culture was based upon the ancient traditions, impulses and sentiments preserved and sung in the great Epic of India, the Mahabharata, which is translated in most of the modern vernaculars.

Sanskrit was once the lingua franca of India. It was language of the learned, as Latin was in Europe in the Middle Ages. 'India, though it has more than 500 dialects, has only one sacred language, only one sacred literature, accepted and revered by all adherents of Hinduism alike, however diverse in race, dialect, rank and creed. That language and literature is Sanskrit, the most ancient language in the world' (Monier Williams). Three-fourths of the population speak dialects derived from Sanskrit, as French, Spanish and Portuguese are derived from Latin. Though there are many dialects, there are only about twelve which cover the whole of India.

Politically, the whole of India is now practically united, and had been so also in the past, notably in the days of Asoka. But the ancient Emperors of India, more liberal than the modern Tzars or Kaisers, never used force to standardize language, culture, creed or caste, but left each group to self-development suitable to its environments.

India, therefore, possesses all the elements of nationality—viz., same blood, same culture, same traditions and same faith.

This Hindu nationality was to a certain extent disturbed by the Mohammedan invasion and Moghul rule, but the overwhelming majority of Moslems are the descendants of Hindus who embraced Mohammedanism, and as such they have retained the language and customs of their respective regions, and are still influenced by the immemorial Hindu culture except in religious matters. 'Century after century our departed ancestors have fashioned our ideas and sentiments' (Le Bon). The change of faith cannot obliterate the work